

dual-sided and transparency printing.

The package includes the driver CD, manuals and a data cable. LED indicators on the front panel alert you in case of a paper jam or when the ink is dangerously low or when the printer is out of paper. The paper tray in this model is not retractable and as a result this printer takes up more desktop space. This printer costs Rs 17,999 and the cost per page is Rs 4.70.



If you are looking for supreme image quality at a respectable output speed, then the HP Deskjet 970CXi should be right up your alley

Lexmark Z13: This printer features a maximum resolution of 1200x1200. It communicates with the PC using the USB interface. Though there is no onboard buffer, this did not impact its printing speed. This printer is quite small and the retractable paper tray further reduces the amount of desktop space it would require. The Lexmark Z13 does not

The Lexmark Z13 is a good bargain for those who require a printer for ordinary text print jobs



Think Before you Buy

- Choose a printer according to the kind of output you plan to print. In general, laser printers offer the best-quality text, and inkjet printers offer the best-quality photos and graphics.
- Make sure to judge a printer by the print speed necessary for the quality level you want to use. The rated speeds for inkjets usually refer to the printer's fastest mode rather than the higher-quality modes you're more likely to use.
- Check the amount of buffer memory on the printer. The more the better.
- Always take a test print of the colour image to see the quality of colour reproduction.
- Check the connections. If your PC doesn't support USB, make sure the printer has a parallel port.
- Consider the total cost of ownership, not just the purchase price. Depending on how many pages you print, a difference of even a rupee per page can save you hundreds of rupees over the lifetime of the printer.
- Check whether the ink levels can be determined through software so that you can tell when to replace the cartridge.
- Check the manufacturer's Web site to make sure the site provides driver updates and tech support information.
- Check the space required for the printer—it should fit into the cabinet or on your desk.

Decision Maker			
	Entry-level printer	Good balance of speed and performance	Super fast speeds with no compromise on quality
You need	A colour printer for occasional printing of Web pages, letters and mostly text documents; very low purchase price. You are okay with slow printing speeds	A printer that allows you to print photographs at high speed, and take prints of large documents. Speed and quality both matter to you	Photo realistic printout with crisp vibrant colours, superior quality for graphics and photos
Look for	An A4 printer with the ability to print colour at a cost per page of less than Rs 5	Speeds of under 30 seconds for text printing and about 5 minutes for a full-colour photo quality printout	Printers with a resolution of 2400x2400, along with additional features to enhance photo printing
Our pick	Cannon S200SP, HP Deskjet 656C and Canon BJC-2100SP	HP Deskjet 845C, Canon S300 and HP Deskjet 920C	HP Deskjet 970CXi, Epson Stylus Photo 810 and Epson Stylus 895
Price range	Rs 4,500 to Rs 6,000	Rs 6,500 to Rs 8,500	Rs 14,000 to Rs 21,000

offer support for dual-sided printing or photo printing, but it does support transparency printing. The driver helps monitor ink levels in the cartridge. Though the image quality of the printer is nothing to write home about, its unbeatable price of Rs 2,990 makes it a good buy. However, you must take into account its per printout cost, which is on the higher side at Rs 8.80.

HP Deskjet 845C: The HP Deskjet 845C is the best value option in the mid-range segment due to its attractive pricing and features. The overall image quality is good and the package includes the driver CD and a data cable. The printer supports photo printing, iron-on transfers and transparency printing. The Deskjet 845C sports good looks but occupies quite some space on the desktop, as the paper tray is not fully retractable.



Give the Deskjet 845C a thumbs up if you are looking for good speed and image quality

Epson Stylus Photo 810: This printer supports both USB and parallel interfaces. An impressive feature is that it supports Print Image Matching technology which creates a direct link with your digital camera, perfectly calibrating a range of settings to create the highest quality images possible. It has support for a resolution of 2880x720 dpi and in case of a paper jam or an out of ink/paper error, the LEDs on the front of the device light up. It supports photo printing, transparency printing and iron-on transfers, but not dual-sided printing. The package includes just the driver CD; there was no data cable or bundled printing media.



Superfast printouts, an impressive array of features and a low cost per page make the Stylus Photo 810 an ideal choice